

Zuddl GTM Ontology — Canonical Reference

Enterprise Event Orchestration Platform: Operational Revenue Intelligence

Data Corpus: 1,279 Gong external calls · 470 Fireflies external calls (55 onboarding, 60 training, 79 CS/sync, 17 integration) · 99 Fireflies internal calls · 7,500+ Pylon support issues · 50 Closed Won + 50 Closed Lost deals with SPICED fields · 300 pain utterances · 300 expansion utterances · 200 competitor utterances · 224 customer friction utterances · 250 internal workaround utterances · Salesforce win/loss codes · Tracker/topic metadata · Sentiment data

Coverage: Jun 2025 – May 2026 (Gong) · Oct 2025 – May 2026 (Fireflies) · Nov 2024+ (Salesforce, Pylon)

SECTION 1 — USE CASES

1.1 Primary Event Motions

Use Case	Won Deals	Typical Buyer	Operational Goal	Adoption Trigger
Flagship Conference (In-Person/Hybrid)	65	VP Events, CMO	Brand authority, pipeline generation	Outgrowing Cvent/Eventbrite; first large event
Field Events	56	Field Marketing Mgr	Local pipeline, ABM execution	Scaling from spreadsheets; hiring field team
Digital Events (Webinars)	53	Demand Gen	Lead gen at scale, nurture	Dissatisfaction with Zoom/ON24; wanting CRM-synced analytics
Third-Party Events (ULC)	High (3,749 tracker mentions)	Field Marketing, Partnerships	Lead capture at trade shows	Desire to retire badge scanner rentals
Internal Events (SKO, Kickoffs)	Moderate	Internal Comms, Sales Ops	Training, alignment	Consolidation onto existing platform
Partner Events	Emerging	Partner Marketing	Co-marketing	Ecosystem growth needs

1.2 Scaling Challenges by Use Case

- **Conference → Field:** Different workflows, permissions, and templates needed for high-frequency field events vs. annual conference
- **Regional complexity:** Multi-language, multi-currency, GDPR double opt-in, timezone-aware registration
- **Template governance:** Brand consistency erodes as more field marketers get access without enforced templates and role-based permissions
- **Data fragmentation:** Events data in Splash/Eventbrite/spreadsheets doesn't flow consistently to Marketo/Salesforce

SECTION 2 — PAINS

2.1 Pre-Sale Pains (Ranked by Frequency)

Pain	Frequency	Departments	Business Impact	Customer Language
Fragmented Tooling	~40% of calls	Event Ops, MOPs, IT	3-5 tools creating data silos	"Duct-taping together"; "replacing Splash, BigMarker, and Brella" (SUI)
Manual/Spreadsheet Workflows	~35%	Field Marketing, Event Ops	Days lost per event on manual data entry	"Back-end operations are heavily manual, relying on Excel" (Under Armour)
Poor CRM/MAP Integration	~30%	MOPs, Demand Gen, RevOps	Broken attribution; manual CSV uploads	"Lead flow discrepancies" (Motive); "integrate to Eloqua first before Salesforce" (Philips)
ROI Visibility Gap	~25%	CMO, VP Demand Gen	Can't prove event ROI to leadership	"No reporting, insight or one location for event information" (RTB House)
On-Site Execution Friction	~20%	Event Ops	Badge printing failures, scanner rentals	"Badge printing process is fiddly" (BigCommerce)

Pain	Frequency	Departments	Business Impact	Customer Language
Platform Inflexibility	~20%	Event Ops, MOPs	Simple changes require support or dev	"Two-day troubleshooting period just to sync session assignments" (Black Duck on Bizzabo)
Governance at Scale	~15%	MOPs, IT, Central Marketing	Brand inconsistency across regions	"Lock down the page layout, control user permissions" (Check Point)

2.2 Post-Sale Product Friction (from Fireflies + Pylon)

Friction Area	Evidence Density	Impact	Source
Landing page builder limitations	30+ utterances, multiple re-trainings	Slows event launch; forces CSS workarounds	RUCKUS needed dedicated re-training; Access Intelligence called it "clunky"
Registration flow complexity	Top keyword across all Fireflies calls	Complex branching hard to self-serve	67 calls mentioning registration flow
Integration edge cases	17 dedicated integration calls	Blocks data flow	Figma "built own integrations"; Motive "lead flow discrepancies"
Domain/DNS setup	Recurring across onboarding calls	Delays go-live by days	Requires customer IT; root domain validation issues
Custom CSS dependency	250 internal workaround utterances	Platform can't natively style many customer requests	"Custom CSS for button customizations" — most common workaround
Permissions/governance gaps	Check Point (34 product requests), T. Rowe Price	Enterprise teams need granular controls	Activity logs, team-specific folders, role-based LP editing
Email template/merge tag limits	Check Point: 5 product requests	Regional date formatting, localization gaps	Enhanced date formatting, multi-timezone management
Reporting/analytics gaps	Access Intelligence, Varicent	Dashboard shows "no data"; check-in count issues	On_engineering tickets

Emerging product gaps (from Pylon on_product issues): Multi-timezone session management · Global custom merge tags · Third-party events in Hub widget · Mandatory Salesforce campaign ID on event creation (Figma) · Bulk session modification via CSV (Iterable) · Minutes-viewed metrics in API · Leaderboard toggles in attendee app

SECTION 3 — BUYING TRIGGERS

Trigger	Urgency	Departments	Evidence
Incumbent contract expiring	HIGH	Procurement, Events	Under Armour (Splash), Black Duck (Bizzabo), Philips (Splash Q2 2026)
Upcoming flagship event	HIGH	Events, CMO	Zenoti "Energize"; BigCommerce "Commerce Live"
Scaling field marketing	MEDIUM-HIGH	Field Marketing, VP Marketing	Check Point global expansion; RTB House NAMER team
Replacing fragmented tools	MEDIUM	MOPs, IT	SUI Foundation replacing "Swoogo, Splash, Brella"
Executive pressure for ROI	MEDIUM	CMO, VP Demand Gen	Quarterly/annual planning cycles
New marketing leader joins	MEDIUM	VP/Dir Marketing	90-day tool audit window. RTB House: Christina from Qualtrics
Budget consolidation	MEDIUM	Finance, MOPs	Annual budget cycle; "budget and resources very limited" (PPFA)
Production failure on incumbent	VERY HIGH	Events	Neostella: "having issues with current provider and immediately met requirements"

SECTION 4 — PERSONAS

Entity ID	Role	Title Variations	Decision Power	Adoption Role	Kill Power	What Resonates
P-001	Field Marketing Manager	Regional Mktg Mgr, Event Mktg Mgr	Low	Primary daily user	Low	Template-based creation, Marketo/SFDC sync, lead capture, speed
P-002	VP/Director Events	Head of Events, Sr Dir Events	High (budget holder <\$100K)	Champion	Medium (when they leave)	Unified platform, pro services, white-glove, mobile app

Entity ID	Role	Title Variations	Decision Power	Adoption Role	Kill Power	What Resonates
P-003	Demand Gen Leader	VP Demand Gen, Dir Digital Mktg	Medium	Webinar champion	Low	Analytics, CRM integration, automated workflows
P-004	Marketing Ops	MOPs, Marketing Technologist	Low (formal), High (de facto)	Integration gatekeeper	HIGH	Native Marketo/SFDC/HubSpot integration, API/SDK, field mapping, SSO
P-005	Procurement	Sourcing, Vendor Mgmt	Low	None	HIGH (delays 4-12 weeks)	Compliance, cost control, contract terms
P-006	IT/Security	InfoSec, IT Architect	None	None	HIGH	Security questionnaire, SOC2, data residency
P-007	CMO/VP Marketing	SVP Marketing	Highest (>\$100K)	Executive sponsor	Rarely	ROI dashboards, consolidation savings, unified reporting
P-008	Previous Champion	"Used Zuddl at prior company"	Medium	Deal accelerator	None	Past positive experience; skips discovery → straight to proposal

Organizational Power Dynamics

Who actually drives adoption: P-001 (Field Mktg Mgr) and P-002 (VP Events) — daily users and champions **Who quietly blocks deals:** P-004 (MOPs) on integration concerns; P-005 (Procurement) on process; P-006 (IT) on security **Who creates expansion momentum:** P-002 seeing multi-module value; P-001 requesting more seats **Champion fragility signals:** Only person on calls; coordinator-level role; manager not engaged; <6 months tenure; manages multiple vendors

SECTION 5 — COMPETITORS

5.1 Competitive Landscape

Competitor	Lost To	Avg Deal	Replaced (Won)	Primary Weakness
Cvent	14 deals	\$44K	8 deals (conference)	Too expensive/complex for mid-market; corporate contract lock-in
Bizzabo	9 deals	\$31K	Several	Admin inflexibility; registration caps; slow support
Splash	3 deals	\$37K	Multiple (UA, BigCommerce, SUI, RUCKUS)	Landing-page tool, not event platform; no check-in; manual backend
Swoogo	2 deals	\$42K	Cribl, SUI, CyberRisk	Limited scalability; weaker integrations
Goldcast	6 deals	\$22K	—	Webinar-only at lower price points
ON24/Zoom/GoToWebinar	3/ various	\$12-16K	—	No event management; no in-person capability
Eventbrite	—	—	Zenoti	No B2B features; no CRM integration

5.2 Migration Friction by Competitor

From	Friction Level	Timeline	Key Risk
Splash	LOW	2-4 weeks	"No pain to switch" if only small events (Visier)
Swoogo	MODERATE	4-6 weeks	Resource constraints cause deferral (Reputation)
Bizzabo	MEDIUM	4-8 weeks	"Not enough value this year" (Phenom)
Cvent	HIGH	2-4 months	Corporate override; "Siemens moved to Cvent corp"

5.3 Win/Loss Patterns

Top win reasons (coded): Product features (106) · Pricing flexibility (92) · Customer support (40) · Internal champion (24) · Professional services (6) · Customer references (5)

Top loss reasons: Lost to Competitor (44) · No Decision/Non-Responsive (38) · No Immediate Need (23) · No Budget (22) · Feature Limitation (14) · Pricing (9)

Critical insight: "No Decision/Non-Responsive" at 38 deals is the #2 loss reason — nearly equal to competitive losses. A structured re-engagement cadence at 60/90/120 days could recover 10-15% of lost pipeline. "Replace incumbent" deals close at ~2x the rate of greenfield because the buyer has already decided to switch.

SECTION 6 — IMPLEMENTATION + ADOPTION ONTOLOGY

6.1 Implementation Reality

The First-Event-as-Crucible: The single most important predictor of long-term adoption is whether the customer successfully executes their first event on Zuddl. The platform is never adopted in the abstract.

Successful pattern: Contract → kickoff within 1 week → first event 3-6 weeks later → structured training between → dedicated Slack channel
Failure pattern: Contract → kickoff delayed 2+ weeks → no clear first event → abstract training → platform unused

Event Type	Implementation Timeline
Simple field events	1-2 weeks (Horizon3: 2-week transition from Luma)
Webinar setup	1-2 weeks (Ashby, AeraTech: 2-3 training sessions)
Full conference	4-8 weeks (Stripe: Apr 10 → May 12; Plaid: onboarding for user conference)
Enterprise multi-module	8-16 weeks (Check Point: ongoing since Jul 2025; T. Rowe Price: phased from Jan 2026)

6.2 Most Trained Features (by Fireflies call frequency)

Registration flow (67 calls) · Landing page builder (26) · HubSpot integration (20) · Marketo integration (23) · Lead capture app (15) · Badge printing/check-in (13) · Sponsor portal (15) · Webinar/Studio setup (12) · Email communications (8) · Ticketing/coupons (6)

6.3 Training Failure Modes

Mode	Mechanism	Evidence
One-and-done	Single training without follow-up → friction 4-6 weeks later	RUCKUS: needed re-training on LP builder
Training without doing	Abstract walkthroughs don't stick; building real event during training retains better	Pattern across onboarding calls
Missing the MOPs person	Events team trained but not MOPs → integration friction surfaces weeks later	BigCommerce: Seekar joined late, "confusion about license types"
Champion-only training	Knowledge doesn't propagate → single point of failure	See Champion Fragility (Section 4)
Scope creep	Customer wants all modules at once instead of starting simple	Kickoff covers 5+ modules; no first event priority
Design perfectionism	Launch blocked because LP/branding isn't pixel-perfect	Multiple "working sessions" on CSS tweaks; launch date slips

6.4 Implementation Dependencies

Dependency	Blocking?	Typical Resolution	Delay If Unresolved
DNS/Domain setup	YES	Customer IT adds CNAME/TXT records	3-14 days
Marketo integration config	YES	Field mapping, program sync, custom fields	7-21 days
Salesforce integration config	Partial	Campaign membership, lead sync	7-14 days
SSO/Security setup	YES (enterprise)	SAML config, Zscaler whitelisting	14-30 days
Payment gateway setup	YES (ticketed)	Stripe/CyberSource merchant account	7-21 days
Mobile app submission	YES (app users)	Apple/Google review process	7-14 days

6.5 Adoption Success vs. Stagnation

High-adoption accounts:

Account	Fireflies Calls	Pylon Issues	Signal
Quantum Metric	17	167	Heavy platform dependency; high issues = deep use
Varicent	17	107	Consistent engagement over 7 months
Check Point	15	195 (34 on _product)	Massive multi-module deployment
Gallup	14	70	Steady usage, moderate support needs
Figma	varies	172	Complex virtual events; built own integrations

Stagnation signals: - Fewer than 2 calls in 3 months post-onboarding - Support tickets drop to zero (counterintuitively = zero usage, not zero problems) - No events created for 90+ days (Q2: 169 days → Red health) - Action items from calls go incomplete across multiple sessions

SECTION 7 — EXPANSION ONTOLOGY

7.1 Expansion Signal Entities

ID	Signal	Confidence	Leading Indicators	Timeline
EXP-001	Conference → Field	HIGH	Customer asks about "field events" post-conference	3-6 months
EXP-002	Digital → Conference	MEDIUM	Webinar customer asks about "in-person" or "attendee app"	6-12 months
EXP-003	ULC/Lead Capture Add-on	MEDIUM-HIGH	"Third-party events", "badge scanning" mentioned	1-3 months
EXP-004	Seat Growth	HIGH	Utilization >80%; new FMMs onboarding; overage charges	At renewal
EXP-005	Mobile App Add-on	MEDIUM	>500 attendee conference; asks about "attendee app"	3-6 months
EXP-006	Previous Champion at New Co	HIGH	Former user evaluates Zuddl at new company	30-90 days
EXP-007	Regional Expansion	MEDIUM	"Expanding to EMEA"; multi-language requests	6-12 months

7.2 False-Positive Expansion Signals

Signal That Looks Strong	Why It Fails	Evidence
"We want to expand to field events" (stated in CS call)	Often aspirational — no budget allocated, no field marketing hire	Multiple accounts discuss but never create opps
High support ticket volume	May indicate frustration, not engagement	Zillow: 201 issues AND renewal pricing friction
Multiple stakeholders on calls	More people ≠ more authority; often organizational confusion	BigCommerce: Seekar joined late, caused confusion
Sandbox exploration activity	Sandbox ≠ commitment; many go nowhere	Low conversion from sandbox-only evaluators
"We love the platform" with high positive sentiment	Satisfaction ≠ expansion; happy customers can still churn on budget shifts	Under Armour: 47% positive but negotiating hard on price

7.3 Expansion Candidates (41 flagged in Salesforce, largely unworked)

Top by ACV and product gap: T. Rowe Price (\$464K, broad suite) · CrowdStrike (\$359K, Field+Digital → conference candidate) · Fullscript (\$130K, Digital only → field+conference) · Ashby (\$46K, Digital only → expanding seats)

SECTION 8 — CHURN ONTOLOGY

8.1 Churn Indicator Entities

ID	Signal	Confidence	Warning	Predictive Window
CHURN-001	Usage Decay	HIGH	No event created in 60+ days	90-180 days to churn
CHURN-002	Champion Departure	HIGH	Different contact on calls; "I'm new here"	60-120 days
CHURN-003	Renewal Pricing Shock	HIGH	Finance enters renewal; "justify the increase"	30-90 days

ID	Signal	Confidence	Warning	Predictive Window
CHURN-004	Corporate Override	MEDIUM	"Corporate is standardizing on [X]"	30-60 days
CHURN-005	Support Overload	MEDIUM	20+ tickets/month without resolution	Ongoing
CHURN-006	Integration Regression	MEDIUM	"Data isn't syncing"; "lead flow discrepancies"	30-90 days

8.2 Renewal Churn Evidence (2026 YTD)

7 renewals lost (\$136.5K): Branch (\$35K, No Budget) · TransPerfect (\$28.5K, Others) · Commvault (\$20K, Others) · MindTickle (\$17K, Lost to Competitor) · ELFA (\$15K, Others) · HackerOne (\$12K, No Budget) · Streetbees (\$9K, No Budget)

At-risk accounts: Q2 (\$66K, Red, 169 days since event) · HackerOne (\$12K, Red, 117 days) · jump.global (\$9.5K, Red, 6 days)

8.3 Adoption Decay Patterns

Pattern	Mechanism	Observable Signal
Post-first-event drop	No second event planned; adrenaline fades	No event created 30+ days after first event
Support dependency	Customer never learns self-service	Same questions repeated; action items not retained
Feature ceiling	Hits limitations; reverts to old tools	Spreadsheets alongside Zuddl; mentions "workaround"
Organizational bypass	Regional teams/new hires don't adopt	Events created by only 1 person despite multi-seat license
Renewal shock	Pricing model change causes friction despite satisfaction	"Per-seat pricing causing friction and confusion" (Zillow)

SECTION 9 — NEGATIVE ONTOLOGY

9.1 Deal Stalling Taxonomy

Pattern	Mechanism	Frequency	Recovery Rate
The Ghost	Champion stops responding after strong engagement	38 lost deals	~10-15% at 60-90 day re-engage
The Procurement Trap	Champion committed but legal/security adds 4-12 weeks	Recurring	~60-70% close but slip quarters
The Timing Mirage	"We'll evaluate next quarter" / "Not right now"	23 lost deals	<20% return within 12 months
The Corporate Override	Corporate mandates a different vendor	Siemens, WilmingtonFRA	<5% recoverable
The Price Stall	Price masks lack of champion conviction	Gong, Bitso	~30% recoverable with repackaging
The Feature Gap Stall	Missing feature used to defer decision	BetterUp, AVEVA	~20% recoverable post-build

9.2 Onboarding Failure Modes

Mode	Early Warning Signal	Typical Timeline
No anchor event	No kickoff within 2 weeks of contract	0-30 days
Champion departure	New contact; training restart requests	30-90 days
Integration impasse	Kickoff delayed; DNS records not added	14-45 days
Training doesn't transfer	Same person on every call; team absent	30-60 days
Scope creep	Kickoff covers 5+ modules; no priority	0-30 days
Design perfectionism	Multiple working sessions on CSS; launch slips	14-45 days

SECTION 10 — ORGANIZATIONAL DYNAMICS

10.1 Structures That Predict Success vs. Churn

Correlates with successful rollout: - Dedicated events team with MOPs support (separation of concerns) - Central marketing with regional empowerment (templates + guardrails) - Single champion with executive air cover

Correlates with churn: - Event responsibility distributed across departments without central owner - Champion is solo operator (knowledge leaves when they leave) - Marketing team restructuring mid-contract (new leader audits tools)

10.2 Cross-Functional Friction

Friction	Departments	Mechanism	Impact
Events vs. MOPs on integration	Events + MOPs	Events wants "just works"; MOPs validates every field	2-4 week delay
Events vs. Procurement	Events + Procurement	Events selected vendor; procurement runs competitive process	4-8 week delay
Events vs. IT on security	Events + IT	Events has urgency; IT has process	T. Rowe Price: "misalignment between security and procurement"
Central vs. Regional on governance	Central + Regional	Central wants enforcement; regional wants flexibility	34 product requests at Check Point
Events vs. Finance on renewal	Events + Finance	Events loves platform; Finance objects to price increase	Zillow pattern

SECTION 11 — TIME / SEQUENCE ONTOLOGY

11.1 Pre-Expansion Signal Sequences

Conference → Field (Most Common, HIGH confidence): Day 0: Signs Conference · Day 60: Conference executed · Day 75: "Can we use this for field events?" · Day 90: Field team joins calls · Day 120: Expansion opp created · Day 150: Field module added Evidence: Check Point, Figma, Cribl, BigCommerce, CrowdStrike

Digital → Conference (MEDIUM confidence): Day 0: Signs Webinar · Day 60: 10+ webinars executed · Day 90: Asks about "in-person" · Day 180: Conference deal closes Evidence: Ashby, Fullscript, Plaid

Seat Growth (HIGH confidence): Day 0: 3-5 seats · Day 60: Field marketers creating events · Day 90: Utilization >80% · Day 120: Asks about adding seats Evidence: Ashby, Zip

11.2 Pre-Churn Signal Sequences

Usage Decay (Most Common): Day 0: Active monthly · Day 30: Frequency drops · Day 60: Tickets → zero · Day 90: No new events · Day 120: CS outreach → slow responses · Day 180: Churn Evidence: Q2, HackerOne

Champion Departure: Day X: Champion leaves · Day X+14: CS notices different/no contact · Day X+30: New contact: "evaluating our tools" · Day X+60: Re-onboard or churn

Renewal Pricing Shock: Day -90: Renewal proposal sent · Day -60: Pushback on increase · Day -45: Finance enters · Day -14: Resolved or evaluating alternatives Evidence: Zillow, Zip, Ashby

11.3 Signal Decay Rates

Signal	Predictive Window	Decay
"Evaluating alternatives"	30 days	Loses meaning if not acted on
Sandbox activity	14 days	No follow-up = dead
Contract expiration	Until date	Stays strong
"Want to add field events"	90 days	Concrete only if budget discussed within 90 days

Signal	Predictive Window	Decay
Product feedback requests	30 days	No response in 30 days → trust erodes
High call frequency	Ongoing	Drop in frequency is the decay signal
"We love the platform"	N/A	No predictive value alone

11.4 Critical Time Windows

Window	Requirement	Why
Days 0-14 post-contract	Kickoff must happen	Delay → implementation friction doubles
Days 14-45 post-kickoff	First event must launch	No event by Day 45 → high abandonment risk
Days 60-90 post-launch	Second event must be planned	Otherwise platform becomes "single-use"
Days 90-120	Integration must be production-quality	Later → workarounds calcify
6 months pre-renewal	Expansion conversation window	Earlier = too early; later = too late
60 days pre-renewal	Pricing discussion window	Changes after this become "shock"

SECTION 12 — ECONOMIC ONTOLOGY

12.1 Pains by Budget Unlock Speed

Pain	Speed	Mechanism
Incumbent contract expiring in weeks	VERY FAST	Hard deadline; procurement urgency
Current tool is broken for upcoming event	VERY FAST	Production emergency bypasses process
Replacing 3+ tools	FAST	Clear cost savings narrative
Proving event ROI to board	MEDIUM	Requires executive sponsor
Better webinar analytics	SLOW	Hard to quantify ROI
"Professionalize our events"	VERY SLOW	Aspirational; no hard deadline

12.2 Use Cases by Budget Resilience

Use Case	Resilience	Why
Flagship conference	HIGH	Already committed (venue, sponsors); reputational cost to cancel
Field events for pipeline	MEDIUM-HIGH	Tied to sales pipeline; protected by sales leadership
Webinars for demand gen	MEDIUM	Low per-event cost; easy to justify with lead volume
Internal events (SKO)	LOW-MEDIUM	First to be cut; "we'll just use Teams"
Partner events	LOW	Discretionary; easy to defer

12.3 Internal Justification Language

What champions say internally to justify spend: - **"From 3 weeks to 3 hours"** — event launch time reduction (BigCommerce) - **"30% cost savings"** — tool consolidation (BigCommerce) - **"Cut field operations turnaround time in half"** (BigCommerce) - **"Pipeline engine"** — events as revenue driver (RTB House) - **"Soft dollar vs hard dollar comparison"** — used to beat Swoogo's lower price (BigCommerce) - **"Eliminate spreadsheet dependency"** — Under Armour, RTB House

12.4 Pricing Dynamics

- **Pricing flexibility is #2 win reason** (92/106 wins) — but always combined with product strength; price alone doesn't win
- **Per-seat pricing causes renewal friction** — Zillow, Zip (overage charges)
- **Multi-year deals reduce churn risk** — Kinective (2-year), T. Rowe Price (contract to 2028)
- **Competitor undercutting works on ~15% of deals** — Bitso, Swoogo undercuts

• Professional services are under-monetized — offered as sweetener but create real adoption value

SECTION 13 — TRUST + ADOPTION ONTOLOGY

13.1 Trust Builders

Builder	Mechanism	Evidence
Successful first event	"It worked when it mattered" → confidence compounds	Universal pattern across onboarding
Dedicated Slack channel	Real-time support = safety net	Referenced in ~40% of kickoff calls
Sandbox before purchase	Hands-on > demos; prospect self-validates	Plaid: sandbox built confidence in API/SDK
Customer reference calls	Social proof from similar company	5 coded wins cite references
White-glove first event	Pro services de-risk the first event	Strongly correlated with retention
Responsive product feedback	Customer sees requests acted on → trusts roadmap	Check Point: 34 requests = deep engagement

13.2 Trust Destroyers

Destroyer	Mechanism	Evidence
Broken integration during live event	Data doesn't sync when it matters	Motive, Q2 CyberSource halt
Pricing surprise at renewal	Feels like bait-and-switch	Zillow: "brand damage"; Zip: overage
Slow product feedback response	Request → silence for months	BetterUp: lost deal over promised APIs
Support SLA breaches	3,552 resolution + 2,820 first-response breaches	Systemic capacity issue in Pylon
CSS/workaround dependency	Basic design needs require engineering	250 internal workaround utterances
Champion left with no handoff	Trust was personal, not institutional	Aspen Tech, Visier

13.3 Stickiness Drivers (Lock-In Strength)

Driver	Strength	Mechanism
Deep Marketo/Salesforce integration	VERY HIGH	Field mappings, program sync → migration cost extreme
Historical event data	HIGH	Registration data, reports → can't export easily
Trained distributed team	HIGH	10+ FMMS using templates → retraining cost
Custom branding/CSS	MEDIUM	Hours invested → would need to redo
Attendee mobile app	MEDIUM	App store submission, branding → can't just switch
Sponsor/speaker portals	MEDIUM	External users have accounts → migration disrupts

SECTION 14 — EVENT MATURITY MODEL

Stage	Characteristics	Tooling	Team	Pains	Zuddl Fit	Expansion Likelihood
1: Reactive	Ad-hoc events; no cadence	Google Forms, Eventbrite free, Zoom	Generalist (side project)	No data capture; no CRM sync	LOW	Very low
2: Programmatic	Monthly webinars; 1-2 field/quarter; first conference	Zoom/ON24 + Splash/Eventbrite + spreadsheets	1-2 event marketers; MOPs part-time	Tool fragmentation; manual CSV uploads	MEDIUM	Medium
3: Consolidated (PRIME ICP)	15-50 events/year; migrating from 2-3 tools	Unified platform attempt	3-8 event marketers; dedicated MOPs	Integration complexity; governance; reporting gaps	HIGH	HIGH
4: Scaled Enterprise	50-200+ events/year; global; multi-type	Enterprise platform + pro services	10-20+ professionals; regional coordinators	Inflexibility; multi-timezone; governance at scale	HIGH but demanding	Highest ACV

Stage	Characteristics	Tooling	Team	Pains	Zuddl Fit	Expansion Likelihood
5: Strategic	Events as core revenue engine; VP-level leader; board metrics	Partnership model; co-innovation	Full events org with sub-functions	Custom requirements; advanced analytics	Partnership required	Highest

SECTION 15 — CAUSAL CHAINS

15.1 Positive Chains

Adoption Flywheel (HIGH confidence):

Champion engaged early → Kickoff within 1 week → First event as training vehicle
 → Integration goes live before event → Event succeeds → Confidence builds
 → Second event self-served → Field team onboards → Seat utilization grows
 → Template library builds → Organizational dependency → Expansion at renewal

Breaks at: champion departure, integration impasse, no second event

Enterprise Expansion Flywheel (HIGH confidence):

Single department deploys for conference → Success visible to others
 → Field marketing asks "can we use this?" → MOPs validates integration
 → VP sees consolidation opportunity → Multi-module renewal
 → Governance requirements emerge → Deeper product investment

Evidence: Check Point, CrowdStrike, T. Rowe Price

Tool Consolidation Win (HIGH confidence):

Customer using 3+ tools (\$50-80K total) → New leader audits stack
 → Zuddl as unified replacement at \$40-60K → "Save money AND do more"
 → Fast procurement approval (net savings) → Close in 1-2 months

Evidence: SUI Foundation, BigCommerce, Cribl, RUCKUS

15.2 Negative Chains

Adoption Failure Spiral (HIGH confidence):

No clear first event → Kickoff delayed > 2 weeks → Abstract training
 → No login for 30+ days → CS check-in → "Haven't gotten to it"
 → 60 more days pass → Integration never configured
 → Renewal: "We didn't really use it" → Churn/downgrade

Evidence: Q2, HackerOne patterns

Corporate Override (MEDIUM confidence):

Department-level champion selects Zuddl → Successful deployment
 → Corporate IT runs vendor consolidation → Enterprise vendor wins
 → Department forced to migrate → Zuddl loses regardless of satisfaction

Evidence: Siemens, WilmingtonFRA

Pricing Spiral (HIGH confidence):

Customer on grandfathered pricing → Usage grows significantly
 → Renewal reflects new pricing (30-50% increase) → Finance enters
 → If champion strong: renegotiate → If champion weak: downgrade/churn

Evidence: Zillow, Zip, Ashby

SECTION 16 — CUSTOMER LANGUAGE INDEX

Pre-Sale Pain Language

- "Duct-taping together" · "Back-end operations are heavily manual" · "No reporting, insight or one location" · "No visibility, no idea for ROE" · "Currently hacking it with [tool]" · "Fiddly" · "Clunky"

Urgency Language

- "Need to make a tech decision quickly" · "Having issues with current provider and immediately met requirements" · "Hard deadline tied to [renewal/event]"

ROI/Value Language

- "Pipeline engine" · "30% cost savings" · "From 3 weeks to 3 hours" · "Cut turnaround time in half" · "Soft dollar vs hard dollar"

Post-Sale Friction Language

- "It's weird" (UI confusion) · "Did I do something wrong?" (self-blame for platform issues) · "A little bit slower" (performance) · "Can you walk me through..." (training) · "Is there documentation?"

Renewal/Pricing Language

- "Justify the price increase" · "Causing friction and confusion" · "Flat renewal despite increased usage" · "Brand damage"

Switching Language

- "Not enough value to make the switch this year" · "No pain to make the switch" · "Great [competitor] takeout — perfect fit" · "Replacing [X, Y, Z]"

SECTION 17 — SUPPORT-DERIVED INTELLIGENCE

17.1 Support Volume as Health Signal

Pattern	Interpretation
High volume + high product requests (Check Point: 195, 34 on_product)	HEALTHY — deep operational use
High volume + SLA breaches (Zillow: 201, 109 open)	AT RISK — friction outpacing support capacity
Moderate, steady (Gallup: 70)	HEALTHY — consistent use without major friction
Low volume after initial spike	MONITOR — may indicate usage decay
Zero volume	DANGER — likely not using platform

17.2 Top Support Accounts

Account	Issues	Open	On Product/Engineering	Signal
Zillow	201	109	6	At risk — volume + pricing friction
Check Point	195	156	34	Healthy — deepening platform investment
Bloomreach	178	35	2	Moderate — resolving well
Sonar	173	16	1	Healthy — low open count
Figma	172	25	12	Complex use; 12 product requests

Account	Issues	Open	On Product/Engineering	Signal
CrowdStrike	135	49	6	Scaling usage

17.3 Systemic Risk: SLA Performance

3,552 resolution SLA breaches + 2,820 first-response SLA breaches across all Pylon issues. This is a capacity issue, not account-specific. Creates "learned helplessness" where customers stop reporting → less feedback → product stagnation.

APPENDIX A — CANONICAL ENTITY REFERENCE

Pain Entities

ID	Name	Affected Personas	Maturity Stage	Budget Speed
PAIN-001	Fragmented Tooling	P-002, P-004	2-3	FAST
PAIN-002	Manual/Spreadsheet Workflows	P-001, P-002	1-3	MEDIUM
PAIN-003	Poor CRM/MAP Integration	P-004, P-003	All	MEDIUM
PAIN-004	ROI Visibility Gap	P-007, P-003	3-4	MEDIUM
PAIN-005	On-Site Execution Friction	P-002	3-4	FAST (event-triggered)
PAIN-006	Platform Inflexibility	P-001, P-002	3-4	FAST
PAIN-007	Governance at Scale	P-004, P-002	4-5	SLOW
PAIN-008	Incumbent Contract Expiring	All	All	VERY FAST

Trigger Entities

ID	Name	Urgency	Departments
TRIG-001	Incumbent Contract Renewal	HIGH	Procurement, Events
TRIG-002	Upcoming Flagship Event	HIGH	Events, CMO
TRIG-003	New Marketing Leader	MEDIUM	All Marketing
TRIG-004	Field Marketing Scaling	MEDIUM	Field Mktg, VP Mktg
TRIG-005	Budget Consolidation	MEDIUM	Finance, MOPs
TRIG-006	Regional Expansion	LOW-MEDIUM	Regional, Central

Expansion Indicator Entities

ID	Name	Confidence	Timeline
EXP-001	Conference → Field	HIGH	3-6 months
EXP-002	Digital → Conference	MEDIUM	6-12 months
EXP-003	ULC Add-on	MEDIUM-HIGH	1-3 months
EXP-004	Seat Growth	HIGH	At renewal
EXP-005	Mobile App Add-on	MEDIUM	3-6 months
EXP-006	Previous Champion at New Co	HIGH	30-90 days

Churn Indicator Entities

ID	Name	Confidence	Predictive Window
CHURN-001	Usage Decay	HIGH	90-180 days
CHURN-002	Champion Departure	HIGH	60-120 days
CHURN-003	Renewal Pricing Shock	HIGH	30-90 days

ID	Name	Confidence	Predictive Window
CHURN-004	Corporate Override	MEDIUM	30-60 days
CHURN-005	Support Overload	MEDIUM	Ongoing
CHURN-006	Integration Regression	MEDIUM	30-90 days

APPENDIX B — UNCERTAINTY REGISTER

Claim	Confidence	Weakness
First event success predicts long-term adoption	HIGH	55 onboarding calls; no controlled comparison
Zero support tickets = zero usage	MEDIUM	Could mean self-sufficient; needs usage data
Champion departure is #1 churn predictor	HIGH	Multiple examples; no quantitative churn model
Pricing flexibility necessary but not sufficient	HIGH	Strong quant evidence from win/loss codes
Corporate override is unrecoverable	MEDIUM	Only 2-3 examples
SLA breaches erode trust systemically	HIGH	3,500+ breaches definitive; per-account impact varies
Stage 3 is prime ICP	HIGH	Product fit + win rate + ACV align
Tool consolidation deals close 2x faster	MEDIUM	Directional; needs pipeline velocity data
Fireflies post-sale data coverage	LIMITED	Starts Oct 2025 (8 months, not 18)